

A MERMAID'S TALE

Sailors have spoken of seeing mermaids for centuries.

It is thought that the legends may be based on sightings of sea cows.



Mom! I'm here!

A manatee will give birth to a calf every two to three years. The bond between mother and baby is strong and is constantly reinforced with plenty of mouth contact.

The upper lip is very mobile.

Keep on eating

Sea cows are big eaters. They will gobble up to a quarter of their body weight in food every day.

Which is which?

Dugongs have crescent-shaped tails. It is the main visual difference between a dugong and a manatee.

A manatee's long flippers are used to hold food and push it toward the mouth.

Crescent-shaped tail

